

AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1 (v1.0.6)

No video re-encoding; pure remux via mkvmerge. Audio bytes are copied identically.

Purpose:

Remove all **low-bitrate** legacy AC3 and E-AC3 audio tracks.

Result:

"Lean Master" movie contains only video and **high-fidelity audio**, which is retained (TrueHD/AAC 7.1/DTS-HD MA).

Use:

Prepares **mkv** movie for Conversion Engines (DDP51 / Keep71) to generate high-quality, high-bitrate (1024k) E-AC3 5.1 compatibility tracks.

How it differs from AudioRemove-AC3.ps1

Feature	AudioRemove-AC3.ps1	AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1
Engine	FFmpeg	mkvmerge (MKVToolNix)
AC3 detection	codec name match	Matroska CodecID (A_AC3 , A_EAC3)
Progress display	FFmpeg stats	Live block progress bar
Data streams	Dropped with warning	Not applicable (mkvmerge ignores them)
Exit codes	FFmpeg (0 = ok)	mkvmerge (0 = ok, 1 = warnings, 2 = error)

Both scripts produce the same result. Use the mkvmerge version if you prefer MKVToolNix.

Requirements

PowerShell 7.6 - [Click here to Download PS 7.6 \(Windows x64 .msi\)](#)

MKVToolNix 98.0+ - <https://mkvtoolnix.download>

FFmpeg and ffprobe are **not** required for this script. Only mkvmerge is needed.

The script finds `mkvmerge` automatically in this order:

1. System PATH (works if MKVToolNix is installed normally)
2. Same folder as the script (portable fallback)

(Windows 11)

1. Place **AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1** in the same folder as your MKV (or ensure `mkvmerge.exe` is on PATH).
2. Run the script:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1 ".\Movie.mkv"
```

The `-ExecutionPolicy Bypass` only applies to this single run and doesn't change your system settings.

macOS / Linux

1. Place the script in the same folder as your MKV (or ensure `mkvmerge` is on PATH).
2. Make the binary executable (first time only, if using portable fallback):

```
chmod +x mkvmerge
```

3. Run:

```
powershell -File ./AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1 "./Movie.mkv"
```

- The script creates a new file: `YourMovie_remux.mkv` in the same folder.
- If that file already exists, it auto-increments safely.
- Your original file is never modified.

1. Subtitle streams

You can switch subtitle handling at runtime by passing `"-KeepAllSubs"` on the command line:
`Runtime switching is temporary.`

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1  
".\Movie.mkv" -KeepAllSubs
```

To keep all subtitles, change **line 33** in the script. Remember to save the file after changes.

```
[switch]$KeepAllSubs = $false # change to $true to always keep all subtitles
```

\$false : (default): Keeps English and untagged subtitles only. Non-English subtitles are dropped.

\$true : Keeps all subtitles including non-English.

Untagged subtitles (language = `und` or missing) are always kept — their language is unknown so dropping them would be unsafe.

You can also suppress subtitle details from the console output using:

-SubtitleInfo Disable:

```
pwsh -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3-mkvmerge.ps1  
".\Movie.mkv" -SubtitleInfo Disable
```

Subtitles kept or dropped are always reported in the summary table regardless of this setting.

2. Audio Codecs - Kept

Codec Family	Examples
TrueHD	TrueHD 5.1, TrueHD 7.1, TrueHD+Atmos
DTS	DTS Core, DTS-HD MA, DTS-HD HRA
FLAC	All FLAC channel layouts
AAC	AAC LC, HE-AAC, AAC 5.1, AAC 7.1
Opus	Stereo + multichannel
PCM	pcm_s16le, pcm_s24le, pcm_f32le

2.1 Audio Codecs - Removed

Codec Family	Matroska CodecID	Examples
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AC3	A_AC3	Dolby Digital 5.1
E-AC3	A_EAC3	Dolby Digital Plus

AC3 detection uses the internal Matroska CodecID (A_AC3 , A_EAC3)

This makes detection reliable across all mkvmerge versions and language packs.

Safety guards: The script will exit cleanly without creating any output file if:

- No AC3/E-AC3 tracks are found (nothing to remove).
- All audio tracks are AC3/E-AC3 (removing them would leave the file with no audio — this is prevented).

Attachments — Kept

- Fonts, cover art, and any other MKV attachment streams are carried through automatically by mkvmerge. No flag is needed.

Track Order

mkvmerge preserves the original track order from the source file (video → audio → subtitles, in their original sequence) with AC3 tracks removed. Default track flags are carried through unchanged from the source — the script does not modify them.

3. mkvmerge Options Used

Option	Purpose
<code>--gui-mode</code>	Enables structured progress output (#GUI#progress N%) for the live progress bar.
<code>--no-date</code>	Omits the segment creation date. Ensures identical output on repeated runs of the same input.
<code>-o</code>	Sets the output file path.
<code>--audio-tracks</code>	Explicit list of audio track IDs to keep. All others are dropped.
<code>--subtitle-tracks</code>	Explicit list of subtitle track IDs to keep.

-S	Drops all subtitles when none are selected (no English or untagged subs found).
--track-order	Preserves source track order after AC3 removal. Without this, mkvmerge re-sorts by type.

Chapters and global metadata are carried through automatically by mkvmerge — no flag is required.

4. Progress Bar

The bar is **blue** while processing and turns **green** when complete. After finishing, the script prints the output file path, file size before and after (in MiB), space saved, and total elapsed time.

5. Summary Report

After processing, the script prints a color-coded summary table.

Column	Description
TID	mkvmerge track ID from the source file. — for grouped rows (non-English subs, attachments).
Codec	Codec name as reported by mkvmerge.
Action	Kept or Removed or Dropped .
Rule	Reason for the action taken.

Color Coding

- **White** — Video passthrough
- **Green** — Kept audio (non-AC3)
- **Red** — Removed audio (AC3 / E-AC3)
- **Cyan** — Kept subtitles (English or untagged)
- **Yellow** — Non-English subtitles dropped
- **Magenta** — Attachments kept

6. Exit Codes

Code	Meaning
0	Success — output file created, no issues.
0	Clean no-op — no AC3/E-AC3 tracks found, nothing to remove.
1	mkvmerge completed with warnings — output file is still created. Warnings are printed.
2	Aborted — all audio tracks were AC3/E-AC3; removing them would leave no audio. No output file created.
2+	mkvmerge error — remux failed. Any partial output file is deleted automatically.

7. Non-Critical mkvmerge Warnings (Safe to Ignore)

These warnings may appear during remuxing but do not affect output quality.

Warning	Meaning	Impact
The track N has a pixel width/height of 0	Video metadata quirk in source	Safe — copied as-is
No space in name for track N	Track title metadata edge case	Safe
The source file has a non-standard track order	Source was muxed out of order	Safe — <code>--track-order</code> corrects it
Chapters found but no chapter track	Chapter metadata stored differently	Safe — chapters are still carried

Disclaimer

- Always test on a few files before batch-processing your library.
- Keep backups of original media.
- Results may vary depending on source quality and hardware.